

Task 2: Paper

1. Who wrote the paper?

The paper was written by Su Yun, Fang XiuQi, and Yin Jun from the School of Geography, Beijing Normal Univeristy.

2. What is the paper about?

The paper examines how climate change affected grain harvests in China between the Western Han Dynasty and the Five Dynasties (206 BC- 960 AD). The authors reconstructed harvest data from historical records to analyze the relationship between climate conditions (temperature and precipitation) and agricultural yields.

3. When was the paper published?

The paper was published in July 2014. But it was published online first on April 8th, 2014.

4. Where was the paper published (i.e., the journal of publication)?

The paper was published in the journal Science China: Earth Sciences.

5. Why did the author(s) write the paper?

Because they wanted to understand the impact of past climate change on agriculture and society by reconstructing historical harvest data. They explain how climate influenced food security, economic prosperity, and social stability in ancient China, and also talks about current and future climate change.

Task 3: Summary of "The Joy Luck Club"

The first chapter of the novel tells the story of Lindo Jong, who was betrothed at the age of two. She describes the rigid customs of her culture and the oppressive nature of her future mother-in-law. The turning point of her tale is the red wedding candle, which, according to tradition, must not be extinguished before morning to ensure the couple's happiness.

Lindo, a clever and resourceful person, sees an opportunity to escape her fate. She enlists the help of a servant to secretly blow out the candle, and then fabricates a story about the will of the gods, convincing her husband's family that the marriage is cursed. With this clever plan, she successfully has the marriage annulled, freeing herself from servitude and maintaining her honor. This experience highlights her wit and inner strength.

The second chapter focuses on Ying-Ying St. Clair, who recounts a traumatic childhood event during the Moon Festival. While on a boat with her family, she feels ignored and lonely. In a moment of childish mischief, she falls overboard. Although she is rescued, she becomes separated from her parents and feels completely lost. Her encounter with the Moon Lady leaves her with the feeling that she was unable to ask for her true wish, which was to find her own self—a void that haunts her throughout her adult life.

El primer capítulo del libro narra la historia de Lindo Jong, quien, a la edad de dos años, fue prometida en matrimonio. Ella describe las rígidas costumbres de su cultura y la opresiva figura de su futura suegra. El punto de inflexión de su relato es la vela de matrimonio roja, que según la tradición, no debe apagarse antes del amanecer para asegurar la felicidad de los recién casados.

Lindo, siendo una persona astuta y con muchos recursos, ve una oportunidad para escapar de su destino. Utiliza la ayuda de la sirvienta, que secretamente apaga la vela, y posteriormente Lindo inventa una historia sobre la voluntad de los dioses, haciéndoles creer que el matrimonio está maldito. Con esta estratagema, logra que la familia de su esposo anule el matrimonio, liberándose de la servidumbre y manteniendo su honor intacto. Esta experiencia muestra su ingenio y su fuerza interior.

El segundo capítulo se centra en Ying-Ying St. Clair, quien recuerda un evento traumático de su infancia durante el Festival de la Luna. Mientras está en un barco con su familia, se siente ignorada y solitaria. En un momento de travesura infantil, se cae del barco. Aunque es rescatada, se separa de sus padres y se siente completamente perdida. El encuentro con la Dama de la Luna la deja con la sensación de no haber podido pedir su verdadero deseo, el de encontrar su propio ser, un vacío que la persigue durante toda su vida adulta.